



Prayer of St. Francis



- ① **LORD** make me an instrument of *Thy Peace* –
- ② where there is **hatred**, I may *bring love*;
- ③ where there is **wrong**, I may *bring the*
spirit of forgiveness;
- ④ that where there is **discord**, I may *bring harmony*;
- ⑤ where there is **error**, I may *bring truth*;
- ⑥ where there is **doubt**, I may *bring faith*;
- ⑦ that where there is **despair**, I may *bring hope*;
- ⑧ where there are **shadows**, I may *bring light*;
- ⑨ where there is **sadness**, I may *bring joy*.
- ⑩ Lord, grant that *I may seek* rather
to comfort, than to be comforted;
- ⑪ *to understand*, than to be understood;
- ⑫ *to love*, than to be loved ...

*for it is by self-forgetting that one finds;
it is by forgiving that one is forgiven;
it is by dying that one awakens to eternal life.*

"Sought through prayer and meditation to improve our conscious contact with God as we understood Him, praying only for the knowledge of His will for us and the power to carry that out."

Combining the practical with the spiritual

I would like to share with you my method of prayer and meditation using the Prayer of St. Francis - a method which has proven to be the final phase in my being lifted from the depths of the insanity of alcohol and alcoholism ... freeing me from the bondage of self.

Beginning on page 49, I have outlined my ABC's for *taking action* with the *Prayer of St. Francis*. In short, I have taken the Prayer of St. Francis (12 n' 12, pg 99) and divided it into 12 sentences (see pg 47). Each day, upon awakening, I take a few moments to contemplate each of the 12 sentences and their meaning in my life and the world about me. As I meditate upon their implications, I determine how I may put each thought *into action* in my *everyday* living.

I spend 24 hours on each sentence. For example, sentence 1 implies peacefulness. During that 24 hour period and *to the best of my ability*, I attempt to bring peace into all of my affairs. When driven by fear and selfishness or tempted by anger and frustration - dishonesty or deceit - I retreat to this meditation and take only the actions which will bring peace to the situation.

When finished with sentence 1, and before retiring for the day, I make notes about my experiences related to this exercise and move on to sentence 2 the following day, utilizing the same method as before ... and so on until I have completed all 12 sentences. When finished with all 12 sentences, I start anew with sentence 1, *again and again and again*.

As you proceed with this method of *prayer & meditation*, you and those about you will soon detect a *(positive) change* in your *attitude and outlook* upon life and life's events.

As you persist with the actions of the Prayer of St. Francis, you will discover that these *ideals* have become a working part of your mind. During periods of *intense emotional disturbance*, you will be empowered to *take action* (upon a specific portion of the prayer) in an effort to calm the disturbance and you will find that this happens *automatically* ... one day at a time. This has been *my experience!*

When falling short of these chosen ideals, as we surely will, accept God's forgiveness and make any reparations necessary ... then continue on as this shall become a lifetime practice.

Take each day as it comes, my friend. You will find harmony and balance within the discipline of these exercises. Go about the business of living *cheerfully and enthusiastically*. In all of your affairs, seek the knowledge and embrace the *power* of God's will. In so doing, you will find - as the Big Book states - that you are *matching calamity with serenity* (AA, pg 68) and you will soon begin to sense the reality of having *become happily and usefully whole* (12 n' 12, pg 15).

*Don't delay - the time to
get "Into Action" ...
is today!*

STEP**11**

"All those who have persisted have found strength not ordinarily their own; wisdom beyond their usual capability and a peace of mind which can stand firm in the face of difficult circumstances." -12 n' 12, pg 191

***The ABC's for taking action with
The Prayer of St. Francis:***

- At the *start* of each day, complete Parts A & B.
- As your day moves along, refer to your 11th Step wallet card *and use it* as a handy reference & reminder tool. On the back side of this card there is a "quick look" spot-check inventory guide which you may utilize at any time during the course of the day.
- When evening comes *and before retiring for the day*, complete Part C.

A

Morning:

1. Review the sentence of the day.
2. Review the definition listed in part A and consider the possible effects this could have upon the day ahead.
3. Contemplate the ideas contained within the paragraph *thoughts / considerations*.
4. Suggested morning readings: Big Book & 12 n' 12.

Then ... move on to Part B.

B

Morning / Day:

1. Entertain the *idea* of _____ as a possible solution to (for) _____.
2. Review the definition listed in part B and consider its application in your daily affairs as it applies to overcoming the effects of _____ (as defined in part A).
3. Review the *ideas* listed within the paragraph designated *meditation* and contemplate this as a method to approaching life for the day.
4. *Then, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!*

C

Evening / Bedtime:

1. Review parts A & B.
2. Contemplate the questions posed in the paragraph entitled *review*. Make notes about your experiences related to these questions in your 11th Step notebook.
3. Review the 12 sentences contained within the spot-check inventory on page 74 and the daily balance sheet on page 75. If a *written* 10th Step is indicated, be sure to complete it *before* retiring for the day.
4. Suggested evening readings: Big Book & 12 n' 12.

Now, turn to page 50 and begin w/sentence 1 ... Channel of Peace.

Channel of Peace

A

"Lord, make me an instrument of Thy peace" ...

Unrest:

*A restless, troubled or uneasy state;
disquiet. Strong almost rebellious
dissatisfaction and agitation;*

Turmoil:

*A state of great commotion,
confusion or disturbance;
tumult; agitation; disquiet;*

- i.e., restless, irritable, discontent.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Is there any element of anxiety apparent to me as I begin my day? What signs of adversity loom within my plans? Do I feel like saying the heck with it all? What can I do to assure harmony in my life? Am I being distracted by negative thoughts or fears at this moment? What can I do to prepare for action this day?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea of peace* as a possible solution to (for) *turmoil & unrest*.

Peace:

A state of mutual harmony between people or groups, esp. in personal relations; cessation of or freedom from any strife or dissension; freedom of the mind from annoyance (calamity), distraction (pomp), an obsession (worship); tranquility, serenity. To make one's peace ... to be reconciled; acquiesce; amend.

Channel of Peace

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will be an instrument of peace. I will begin by asking God to see me through any adversity I may be faced with. I will practice patience, kindness, tolerance and love in all my affairs of the day. I will avoid distraction, obsessive thinking, and I will get along with those with whom I come into contact. I will utilize the Serenity Prayer if I become annoyed, agitated or afraid. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I an instrument of peace today? Was I mentally and emotionally free of distraction and anxiety? Was I free of annoyances? Was I able to avoid obsessive thinking and/or compulsive, impulsive, or excessive behavior today? Did I get through the day with tranquility and serenity? Did I feel or create any strife or dissension as I went through my day? Did I experience mutual harmony within my activities, both in and out of AA? Am I in conflict with anyone about anything right now? Did I exert *my will* in an effort to be superior to anyone? Did I fall short of my *chosen ideals* today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 2, *Hatred / Love*, tomorrow morning.

Hatred / Love

A

"That where there is hatred, I may bring love" ...

Hatred:

Intense dislike or extreme aversion or hostility.

Lacking self-esteem, self-respect, or dignity.

Symptoms: Self-defeating, self-destructive, or self-sabotaging actions (or failure to take needed actions).

Harmful or injurious conduct directed towards others (or oneself); i.e., a person, an institution, a principle of life, or thing.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I secure in myself and these plans? In what ways do I express self-hatred? Do I bring self-destructive or self-defeating behavior into my life? Do I thwart my own intentions or frustrate myself? Am I aware that people who genuinely love themselves do not commit self-defeating or self-destructive acts or failure to act when needed? Do I bring negative personality traits into my arena of life? Will my attitudes play a part in my plans today? What can I do to prepare for action this day?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.

12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of love as a possible solution for (self) *hatred*.

Love:

Affectionate concern for the well being of others; a feeling of warm personal attachment of deep affection; in consideration of; for the sake of others; the benevolent affection of God for His creatures; or the reverent affection due from them to God.

Hatred/Love

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to express self-love. I will not be hostile! I will hold my temper. I will remember "restraint of tongue and pen!" I will not avoid risk for fear of failure, or of how I may look to others. I will show kindness, patience, tolerance, and love toward all others ... especially those whom I dislike. I will not do harm nor cause injury to another. I will be constructive in my daily activities. I will keep a good attitude and portray a positive outlook toward life. I will not procrastinate nor sabotage my efforts and/or intentions. I will follow through. I will be considerate of others. I will be watchful for the sake of another person's well-being. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I complete the day with an aversion or hostility toward any person or entity? Was I able to avoid thwarting or frustrating my own good intentions? Did I do anything harmful or injurious to another person, place, or thing today? Did I avoid self-defeating, self-destructive, or self-sabotaging actions today? Did I fail to act when necessary or called upon in the time of someone's need? Did I avoid any situation or circumstance in my daily affairs due to fear, sloth, indifference, or an attempt to impress or influence another? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom of that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 3, *Wrong / Forgiveness*, tomorrow morning.

Wrong / Forgiveness

A

"Where there is wrong, I may bring the spirit of forgiveness" ...

Wrong:

*Not correct in action, judgement, opinion, method; not proper or usual;
not in accordance with requirements or recommended practices.*

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I conscious of my tendency to fail to act in good judgement? Am I willing to conduct myself in an orderly, proper fashion? Am I willing to comply with known requirements and/or commands? Am I willing to comply with and follow recommended practices, such as on the job, within my community, within AA, and within my own family? Do I have opinions which could adversely affect my day, opinions which are, perhaps, based in wishful thinking rather than fact or evidence? What can I do to prepare for action this day?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *forgiveness* as a possible solution for *wrong*.

Forgive:

*To grant "free" pardon; to give
up all claim of; to cease to
feel resentment against.*

Forgiveness:

*The act of forgiving; i.e.,
disposition or willingness to forgive;
a state of being forgiven.*

Wrong / Forgiveness

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to exercise good judgement in all my affairs. I will be compliant and agreeable without surrendering my independence or integrity. I will resist the desire to rebel against established standards or practices. I will be a good citizen today. I will be law-abiding today. I will keep my unsolicited opinions to myself unless asked, and when asked, I will give an opinion which is based in known fact or evidence. I will not gossip nor rumor-monger. I will be patient. I will not be sensitive. If someone injures me, I will look for the good in them, and act in good faith and forgiveness. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I fail to act in good judgement in any of my affairs today? Was my conduct *today* improper or unusually out of character for me? Did I comply with requirements and/or expectations of myself at home, work, and play today? Did I consciously *rebel* against *any* recommended practice or social expectation today? Were my comments or expressions of opinion today based in fact or just my *wishful thinking*? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 4, *Discord / Harmony*, tomorrow morning.

Discord / Harmony

A

"That where there is discord, I may bring harmony" ...

Discord:

Disagreement / difference of opinion; lack of harmony with others.

Symptoms: being oppositional; contrary; argumentative; forcing unsolicited opinions on others; being an *irritant*; negativism; inciting dissension.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I in disagreement with anyone as I start my day? Is a difference of opinion a factor in my plans? Are my plans conformative, consistent, orderly, and in mutual harmony with those about me? Are my thoughts based in selfish, dishonest, self-seeking, inconsiderate, resentful, or frightened motives? What can I do to prepare for action today?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *harmony* as a possible solution for *discord*.

Harmony:

Agreement, accord, harmonious relation. A consistent, orderly, or pleasing arrangement of parts; congruity. Unity, peace, amity, friendship; consonance, conformity, correspondence, consistency; harmony of parts.

Discord / Harmony

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to be agreeable. I will keep my unsolicited opinion to myself. If I submit my opinion and it is not accepted, *and maybe even criticized*, I will try to remember that everyone has a right to be wrong (including myself) in their opinion along with the right to be right. I will remember that someone can disagree with me and remain a valued and trusted friend, associate, and decent human being. If their disagreement seems to me to be laced with malice, I will Stop, and Think, and Ask questions *before* I Respond. I will respond rather than react. I will entertain the idea that this person is perhaps spiritually sick and I will pray for God's will, and God's blessing, to be bestowed upon them. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Was I agreeable today? Did I express any differences of opinion in a negative manner? Did I impose my opinions or my will upon anyone today? Did I remain harmonious in my affairs throughout the day? Was I consistent, orderly, and conformative in my dealings with others today? Did I give others the right to be wrong today? Was I able to stop myself before reacting and/or overreacting to any uncontrollable circumstances today? Was I at one with the world today? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n° 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 5, *Error / Truth*, tomorrow morning.

Error / Truth

A

"Where there is error, I may bring truth" ...

Error:

Deviation from accuracy or correctness; as a mistake, as in action, speech, etc.; the holding on to of mistaken opinions. The difference between the observed or approximately determined value and the true value of a quantity.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

*What are my plans for today? Am I focused in my actions in an effort to stay on track? Am I having difficulty telling the truth? Am I wanting to mislead anyone to get what I want today? Am I planning something that I know is not fair to all concerned? Am I kidding myself about the value of something I "really" want? Do I have trouble being *direct* in my dealings with others, or am I usually *passive* and indirect? Do I resist conforming to situations and circumstances I do not want to conform with, even though they may in fact be in my own best interest? Do I "tell it the way it is," or do I manipulate the facts to get a desired outcome? What can I do to prepare for action today?*

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *truth* as a possible solution for *error*.

Truth:

The true or actual state of a matter; conformity with fact or reality; verity; a verified or indisputable fact, proposition, principle or the like; i.e., honesty, integrity, truthfulness, accepted fact, truism, platitude, accuracy.

Error / Truth

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will be honest. I will keep my thoughts and actions based in reality and fact. I will tell the truth. I will conform to situations and yet I will stay loyal and true to my chosen ideals. If I am to learn that my personal values are based upon a mistaken opinion, I will have the courage to *let it go* and change my mind, creating a new personal value. I will remain focused and complete my plan for the day. I will be *direct* in my dealings with others. I will ask for what I want or need, and refrain from manipulating others for my own gain. I will *play fair* in my arena of life today. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I remain focused, or did I allow (or create) distractions to alter my plans? Did I make any mistakes today that I have yet to take responsibility for? Were the things I said and actions I took today accurate and consistent with the truth? Did I willfully (knowingly) *hold on to* a mistaken opinion just to "fit in" for the moment at some point today? Did I deviate from my plans, or lie, or tell a half-truth in an effort to get someone to like me, approve of me, or accept me? Did I switch allegiance (loyalty) just to fit in or to look good? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 6, *Doubt / Faith*, tomorrow morning.

Doubt / Faith

A

"Where there is doubt, I may bring faith" ...

Doubt:

To be uncertain about in opinion; hold questionable; hesitate to believe; distrust; to fear; be apprehensive about; a feeling of uncertainty about the truth, reality, or nature of something.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

*What are my plans for today? Am I focused in my objectives? Am I lacking confidence in the reliability of my own personality, thoughts, actions, and motives as I preview my day? Do I have dreams and have I set goals to attain them? Do I believe I can reach them? Do I believe I can get through today successfully? Is there anyone with whom I am acquainted that I have the power to help to realize their hopes, dreams, and goals? Is there something about myself that I am in doubt of today? Am I feeling impending doom or disaster? Am I questioning reality today? Am I afraid of what may lie ahead for me? Am I withholding something from someone which I may need to share with them *today*? What can I do to prepare for action today?*

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *faith* as a possible solution for *doubt*.

Faith:

Confidence or trust in a person or thing; belief in God or in the doctrines or teachings of religion. Belief in anything; as a code of ethics, standards of merit, etc..

Doubt / Faith

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will act in faith. When in doubt, I will contact someone that I trust *will tell me the truth* about my circumstances, thoughts, or feelings. I will seek someone who has success in the area of living in which I am troubled for their criticism. I will not leave my plans to chance. When faced with a major decision, I will stop and think IRS: Investigate; Research; Scrutinize; *then decide!* I will recite the 7th Step prayer when I feel my strength slipping. If I question someone's comments or motives, I will take it upon myself to search out the facts in an effort to discover the *reality* of the situation. I will ask God to direct my thinking. I will recall the experiences of others, and have confidence and trust that their results can be mine as well. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I accomplish my goals? Did I fail to act in good faith today? Was I reluctant to believe someone today? Did someone question my character or my credibility today? Did I question myself today? Was I mistrusting of anyone, or of a specific circumstance today? Do I have fear right now? Am I feeling apprehensive, insecure, inadequate, or inferior at the moment? Did I fail to do something today because I doubted myself or my abilities? Did I change an opinion or a decision to suit a more dominant personality today, even though I strongly disagreed with them, and maybe even lacked respect for them? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 7, *Despair / Hope*, tomorrow morning.

Despair / Hope

A

"Where there is despair, I may bring hope" ...

Despair:

Loss of hope. That of which there is no hope.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I focused and motivated? Does anything in my arena of life look or appear hopeless as I begin my day? Do I believe my plans are doomed even *before* I begin? Do I feel reluctant to move forward - to *take action*? In doing or approaching most things, do I feel or think "it won't work," even before I give it an honest effort? Is everything about me "gloom and doom?" Do I have the attitude "well, it may work for you, but *never* for me?" Do I believe that no matter what I do, it won't work for me? What can I do to prepare for action today?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12; page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea of hope* as a possible solution for *despair*.

Hope:

*The feeling that what is desired is also possible,
or that what may turn out for the best;*

*A person in whom or thing in which expectations are centered.
To believe, desire or trust.*

Despair / Hope

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will *act as if* I have hope. In all my activities and affairs of the day, I will move ahead even though I may "think" it is hopeless. I will contact someone who I know has found *success* in life for support and direction. I will look back upon some of my recent little victories, including the simple fact that I did not drink today; after all, at one time I "knew" I couldn't stay sober at all ... let alone finish anything I started. I will trust my instincts today as being God given. I will trust infinite God. I believe my dreams are possible if I work hard to realize them. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I accomplish my goals? Did I feel hopeless today? Did I exert my best effort today to combat these feelings of hopelessness? Did it appear to me that my goal could not be met today, and therefore delay action? Did an expectation go unfulfilled? Did I feel let down by someone? Did some situation or circumstance disappoint me or hurt my feelings? Do I feel overwhelmed by today's activities? Did something happen or not happen today to make me feel disparaging, hopeless, or unnecessary? Did I end the day feeling unneeded, unwanted, or unloved? If so, what could I have done differently? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 8, *Shadows / Light*, tomorrow morning.

Shadows / Light

A

"Where there are shadows, I may bring light" ...

Shadows:

Obscurity, gloom, dusk, a slight suggestion; trace; faint, indistinct image or idea. A period or instance of gloom, unhappiness, mistrust, doubt, dissension, or the like. A dominant or pervasive threat, influence or atmosphere; esp. one causing gloom, fear, doubt, or the like; i.e., control, authority, dissent, etc..

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

*What are my plans for today? Am I focused and motivated? For me, shadows can be seen as those thoughts of negativity which I absorb and cast about, the darkness I see in the soul of another, the secrets I keep, and the deceptions of myself and others in which I live. Is God an actual "power" in my life or just an "idea" that gives me temporary relief? Is God *obscured* from my view? Am I sensing or feeling impending calamity? Is there mistrust or dissension in my arena of life as I begin my day? Am I feeling unconsciously anxious, apart from, slightly restless, irritable, and/or discontent with my life or circumstances in my life today? What can I do to prepare for action today?*

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n° 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *light* as being a possible solution for *shadows*.

Light:

State of being visible, exposed to view, or revealed to public notice or knowledge. The information, ideas or mental capacities possessed. To begin to accept or understand a point of view one formerly opposed. To clarify, clean-up, to discover or reveal.

Shadows / Light

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to change my negative thoughts by taking alternative *positive actions*. I will look for the good in those who seem to me to project badness, or who may say or do something unkind or injurious. I will see the brighter side of things when darkness presents itself. If I can see no light, I will call someone, a trusted friend or acquaintance, for their views. I will not lie to nor deceive myself or anyone else today. I will be forthright and direct in my dealings with others today. I will not gossip nor rumor-monger about anyone today. I will keep an open mind - someone may have a better idea or plan! Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I accomplish my goals? Did I feel hopeless today? Did I accomplish the tasks set forth this morning? Was I able to maintain a positive attitude and outlook upon life today? Did I find the good in those whom I had occasion to deal with today, or did I focus on the dark and negative side of their natures? Was I able to see the *brighter side* of circumstances and events today? Did I call someone today in an effort to overcome doubt, fear, mistrust, suspicion, or dissension? Was I honest, straightforward, and direct in my dealings with others today? Did I gossip or help spread a rumor today? Was I happy today? Did I bring happiness into another person's existence today? Did I clear up any misunderstanding or dissension between persons in my arena of life? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n° 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 9, *Sadness / Joy*, tomorrow morning.

Sadness / Joy

A

"Where there is sadness, I may bring joy" ...

Sadness:

The state of being sad; grief; depressed.

Sad:

*Depressed, dejected, melancholy,
willow spirits. Depressed by unhappiness
or grief; sorrowful or mournful;
deplorably bad; (too) sorry.*

Depressed:

*Refers to a temporary lapse in
natural buoyancy because of
fatigue, unhappiness; a sense of
being unable to change unsatisfactory
conditions or the like.*

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I focused and motivated? Am I feeling, or is there sadness in my life today? Have I lost a loved one or a close friend recently? Am I grieving the loss of something I want that I have yet to receive? Am I lonely and afraid? Do I know the difference between dejection, rejection and/or selection; sadness and depression? Am I fatigued as I begin my day? Are there any conditions I have to meet today which are unsatisfactory to me? What can I do to prepare for action today?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n° 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of joy as being a possible solution for *sadness*.

Joy:

*The emotion of great delight or happiness caused by something good or satisfying.
A source of or cause of keen pleasure or delight.*

Sadness / Joy

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to change my attitude toward life, myself, an idea, or an experience. I will *take action* to overcome any ill-fated feelings I may harbor. I will look to find the good that can come from a negative experience. I will relive memories of a person or situation past which brings joy into my being. I can, at any time, reset and restart my goals; perhaps they were unrealistic or unattainable when I set them, given the limitations of my own abilities. I will learn to adjust the expectations I allow others to place upon me, as well as my own. I will keep a clear perspective of my own abilities and limitations. I will allow myself to make mistakes, to be human, to look bad, and yes, even to *grow-up!* Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Where did my successes lie today? Did I avoid being depressed? Did I avoid becoming dejected or melancholy today? Was I happy? Did I bounce back from negativity? Was I able to change my attitude or conditions to a positive note? If I was sad or dejected, did I "dump it" on others, or did I work things out with a friend? Did I avoid feeling rejected today? Did I burn up energy foolishly, leaving myself fatigued? Did I work within my own limitations, or did I misjudge them and leave myself open to self-condemnation, self-loathing, or criticism from others? Did I make mistakes today, look bad in front of others, or fail to act "grown up" at some point in my daily affairs? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 10, to *Comfort*, tomorrow morning.

To Comfort

A

*"Lord, grant that I may seek
rather to comfort, than to be comforted" ...*

Discomfort:

Uneasiness, distress, annoyance, embarrassment; pain, soreness.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I focused and motivated? Is there anything distressing or annoying to me right now that could undermine my day? Am I alert to my selfish, self-seeking nature? Am I aware of the fact that when I am acting selfishly in my arena of life, I bring discomfort to those about me? Do I realize that when I am dishonest or deceitful, I set people ill-at-ease with me? Being inconsiderate and resentful discomforts all involved ... am I cognizant of the fact? Is it apparent to me that fear erodes all peace of mind and serenity? Do I admit I know that when I express anger, impatience, intolerance, or inappropriate desires, that I have placed people at dis-ease; creating disharmony through fear, anxiety, and/or resentment? Do I like to point out other peoples shortcomings, or embarrass them publicly? Do I like to annoy people to make them uncomfortable? What can I do to prepare for action today?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *comfort* as being the possible solution for *discomfort*.

Comfort:

*To soothe or console; to cheer, as someone grieved; to aid, encourage;
relief in affliction; consolation; solace; a feeling of relief or consolation. A cause or matter of relief or
satisfaction. A state of (or being at) ease and satisfaction of bodily (mental & emotional)
wants with freedom from pain and anxiety.*

To Comfort

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to be selfless. I will strive to maintain comfort in my own life. I will look to others' need to be consoled without giving pity or sympathy. I will look to cheer someone who is lonely, depressed, or grieving of an *actual* injury or loss. I will look to encourage someone who may be engulfed in doubt or hopelessness. I will look to bring joy to one who may be afflicted with illness or irreversible circumstance. If I have the where-with-all, I will *help* bring satisfaction to someone in emotional pain without "taking it over" for them. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I accomplish the tasks set forth this morning? Did I bring discomfort into my life or the lives of those about me? Did I avoid or avert selfish, dishonest, self-seeking, inconsiderate, or resentful attitudes and/or actions in my arena of life today? Did I bring comfort to someone in need? Was I able to encourage someone today? Did I help reduce or relieve someone's fear today? Did I feel or experience a sense of ease and comfort in my activities today? Was I kind and tolerant of others? Was I able to stay out of "my own stuff" today? Did I act to good purpose? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 11, to *Understand*, tomorrow morning.

To Understand

A

"To understand, than to be understood" ...

Indifference:

Lack of interest or concern. Unimportant; of little or no concern.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

*What are my plans for today? Am I prepared to meet my responsibilities of the day? Do I have a schedule? Am I focused? Do I acknowledge a general lack of understanding, and that I have much to learn? Do I understand what motivates me as a person? Have I grasped the full implication of what it means to be an alcoholic? When combined with experience, do I believe that knowledge is a *key factor* in gaining understanding? Am I aware that understanding allows for forgiveness and peace of mind? Do I know that understanding brings emotional freedom and security to otherwise dependent and compromised individuals? Am I aware that a grain of understanding could grant pardon to seemingly unforgivable circumstances? What can I do to prepare for action today?*

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of *understanding* as a possible solution for *indifference*.

Understand:

*To grasp the meaning of; to perceive what is meant;
to grasp the significance, implications or importance of;*

To accept as true; believe; to accept tolerantly or sympathetically.

To Understand

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to be understanding. I will remain focused. I will show concern and interest in my plans, and in the welfare of others. If someone commits an injury against me, I will try to understand what motivated them. I will attempt to understand their plight rather than judge their conduct. Today I will search for the truth of a matter to discover what is "really meant" or actually intended. I will look to see the importance of ideas not my own. I will accept something as true (if it is) even through I personally disagree with its application. I will show tolerance for others as I accept them for what and who they really are. I will attempt to grasp the implications of a situation so as to respond appropriately. I will make an extra effort to better understand what motivates me as a person, as a human being, and as a child of God. I will forgive someone today. I will seek forgiveness and make reparations if I have wronged someone today. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I accomplish the tasks set forth today? Did I express concern and interest in the events of my day? Did I accept an opportunity to gain self-understanding by understanding another individual's plight in life? Was I tolerant and accepting of others today? Did I perceive reality as it was today, or did I try to fashion it to my wishes, desires, or demands? Did I experience serenity, tranquility, or peace of mind as a result of understanding today? Did I help anyone better understand themselves or their circumstances as they passed through my arena of life today? Did I gain any insights or perspectives into the idea that I am a child of God? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 12, to *Love*, tomorrow morning.

To Love

A

"To love, than to be loved" ...

Ambivalence:

The coexistence within an individual of positive & negative feelings toward the same person, object or action; drawing him in opposite directions.

Uncertainty or fluctuation, esp. when caused by inability to make a choice or by a simultaneous desire to say or do two opposite things.

THOUGHTS / CONSIDERATIONS:

What are my plans for today? Am I focused and motivated? Am I prepared to meet my responsibilities today? Do I need anyone's assistance to meet my goals? Is my day structured in an orderly fashion? Did I leave time for family, friends, and especially to play today? Am I being torn in two different directions involving a decision I need to make regarding a person or situation? Can I see to love as to bring the action of care and concern into my arena of life? What can I do to prepare for action today?

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, line 19 - page 88.
12 n' 12: page 102, line 14 - line 15, page 103.

B

Entertain the *idea* of love as a possible solution for *ambivalence*.

Love:

In consideration of; for the sake of; an affectionate concern for the well-being of others; the benevolent affection of God for his creatures or the reverent affection due from them to God. A feeling of warm personal attachment or deep affection.

To Love

(B)

MEDITATION:

Today, to the best of my ability, I will attempt to be loving. I will seek to express only love in my actions. I will see to the well-being of someone in my arena of life today. I will be careful to avoid selfish, dishonest, self-seeking, inconsiderate, or resentful actions. I will let someone know today that I love them. I will go out of my way to let someone who may feel lonely and afraid know that God loves them as He does all His kids. I will acknowledge that all things good are of God. I will carry a message of love through unselfish, kind, and tolerant actions today. I will not be self-defeating, self-destructive, nor self-debasing, just for today. Thy will be done.

Now, go on about the business of living today ... cheerfully and enthusiastically!

C

REVIEW:

Was I able to meet and complete my plans for the day? Did I follow through on my schedule? Was I kind and loving towards all ... even my *enemies*? Did I look for ways to express love without being caught up in frothy emotional appeal? Did I misuse the *power of love* to gain something motivated by selfishness, lust, greed, or the like? Did I let someone know that I love them or that they are loved by God today? Did I aid in the well-being of another person today? Did I *play fair* today? Was I tolerant and accepting of others in my arena of life today? Did I act lovingly today in all my affairs? Did I fall short of my chosen ideals today? Write about your experiences today in your 11th Step notebook.

Review page 74 herein and, if indicated, complete a *written* 10th Step.

SUGGESTED READINGS:

Big Book: page 86, lines 5 - 18.
12 n' 12: page 93, line 17 - page 95.

EXTRA CREDIT:

Turn to page 75 and follow the directions at the bottom that page.

Step Ahead to sentence 1, *Instrument of Peace*, tomorrow morning.

- 1 - Was I *selfish, dishonest, or inconsiderate* with anyone today?
- 2 - Did I *arouse anger* in anyone during the course of the day? Did I *hurt anyone's feelings* today? Did I *deprive anyone* of their *worldly goods*, their *emotional security*, or their *peace of mind* today? Did I excite *jealousy* or *misery...suspicion* or *bitterness*? Did I provoke a desire in anyone *to retaliate* today? Do I owe *an apology*?
- 3 - Did I feel *angry, hurt, resentful, afraid, guilty* or *ashamed* in relation to a circumstance, condition, person or event which was part of my day today?
- 4 - Was I kind and loving towards all in my arena of life today? And did I remember that *love and tolerance* of others *is our code*? If not...

It would serve me well to discipline myself in *the prayer of tolerance*: "Please, Lord, *help me to believe* that this person is doing their *very level best* at this precise moment in time. *God save me* ... from being angry, critical, or judgmental. Thy will be done." *It works - it really does!*

- 5 - Is there something I could have done better during my day?
- 6 - Was I thinking of myself most of the day?
- 7 - Was I thinking of what I could do for others during the course of my day or of what I could pack into the stream of life *today*?
- 8 - Did I avoid falling into *worry, remorse* and/or *morbid reflection* today? Am I keeping something to myself *now* which should be discussed with another person *at once*?
- 9 - Did I attempt to rely upon *self-sufficiency (self-reliance, self-confidence)*, being "*cocky*" or exhibiting "*bluster*") in my dealings with the world and it's people today, only to have it fail me?
- 10 - Did my actions today indicate I have ceased fighting anything or anyone?
- 11 - Am I seeing that truth, justice, and love are the real and eternal things in life and in the world about me?
- 12 - At times of anxiety, stress and/or indecision *today*, was I able to **Stop, Think, Ask** for help, and then **Respond** (rather than react)? And did I **stop, think, and ask** God ... to grant me *Serenity to accept* the things *I could not change*, for *Courage to change* the things I could, and for *Wisdom to know* the difference ... before I responded or reacted? Just for today ... *think* (★) **S.T.A.R.!**

If you answer *yes* to #1, 2 or 3, or *no* to #10, a *written (10th Step) inventory* is indicated and suggested, ideally before day's end. (Adapted from the "Big Book" & the 12 n' 12.)

Daily Balance Sheet:

*a continuous look at our
assets and liabilities...*

Characteristics of Self-Will:

- Selfish ☐
- Dishonest ☐
- Self-Seeking ☐
- Inconsiderate ☐
- Resentful ☐
- Frightened ☐
- Pride ☐
- Anger ☐
- Envy ☐
- Greed ☐
- Lust ☐
- Sloth ☐
- Gluttony ☐
- Impatient ☐
- Intolerant ☐
- Irritable ☐
- Argumentative ☐
- Anti-Social ☐
- Self-Condernation ☐
- Self-Importance ☐
- Self-Justification ☐
- Self-Pity ☐
- Suspicion / Doubt ☐
- Harmful / Hateful Acts ☐

Characteristics of God's Will:

- ☐ Interest In Others
- ☐ Honesty
- ☐ Concern for Others
- ☐ Consideration
- ☐ Forgiveness
- ☐ Courage
- ☐ Humility / Seek God's Will
- ☐ Calmness
- ☐ Gratitude
- ☐ Giving Or Sharing
- ☐ What We Can Do For Others
- ☐ Take Action
- ☐ Moderation / Balance
- ☐ Patience
- ☐ Tolerance
- ☐ Good-Natured
- ☐ Agreeable
- ☐ Communicative
- ☐ Understanding / Insightful
- ☐ Modesty / Self-Forgetting
- ☐ Truth / Condition of Being
- ☐ Acceptance & Change
- ☐ Trust / Faith
- ☐ Good Deeds

Review both columns, checking the boxes of those characteristics which applied to you as you went about your day. Make notes in your 11th Step notebook about their impact in your day's activities. Describe the **effects produced** as the result of the actions you took (*or failed to take*) in relation to these characteristics. *Pssstt!* Remember folks, "it's about progress ... not perfection!"

Feel free to review pages 80 and 81 where we have listed additional characteristics of both a positive and negative nature.

Step 12

"Having had a spiritual awakening as the result of these steps, we tried to carry this message to ALCOHOLICS and to practice these principles in all our affairs."

"The *joy of living* is the theme of AA's twelfth step, and *action* is its key word."

When it comes to carrying the AA message, Silkworth states -- in *The Doctor's Opinion*, AA -- "The message which can interest and hold these alcoholic people must have **depth** and **weight**." This "message" is most effective when delivered in such a manner that a still suffering alcoholic of whatever description -- whether a prospect, newcomer, or veteran member -- may have an opportunity to make **an accurate identification of their problem** (depth) and have made known to them **a solution for that problem** (weight). In fact, any sober AA can effectively carry the message when asked to speak at an AA meeting provided he or she is taking (has taken) the Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous, and follows a few simple suggestions.

Twelve steps to delivering an effective AA talk:

- 1) Dress appropriately, respectfully, and be on time.
- 2) Introduce yourself as an alcoholic (only), avoiding the use of multiple identification. Extend thanks and gratitude.
- 3) Greet the newcomers and invite them into the fellowship of AA.
- 4) Mention briefly your family background prior to drinking (in a **very** general way).
- 5) Share your drinking history as it exemplifies the progressive nature of the **illness of alcoholism** -- as outlined in the Basic Text of AA -- beginning with your first drinking experience whereby you realized the ("abnormal") **effect produced** by alcohol.

*To avoid confusing and/or alienating newcomers, respect AA's **singleness of purpose**. Minimize historical accounting of problems other than those directly related to alcohol; i.e., drug addiction/use, compulsive overeating, the child within, being a "victim," psychology today, etcetera, as we want them to primarily identify with alcohol use and the progression of alcoholism.*

- 6) Relate pertinent elements of *The Doctor's Opinion* as you share your drinking history / experience.
- 7) Side-step the use of vulgar and obscene language while sharing as we are a **program of attraction** and that is surely a distraction. It presents a negative community image of our AA way of life to those "outside" who may be visiting with us to learn about alcoholism and Alcoholics Anonymous.
- 8) Describe events surrounding your hitting bottom and what led you to AA.
- 9) Mention the importance of having a Sponsor, a Home Group; and of "taking" the Steps.
- 10) Mention your experience with service work, working with others, and benefits you realized as a result thereof.
- 11) Share a personal experience or two that resulted from developing a personal relationship with God, *as you understand Him*.
- 12) Summarize your pitch. Invite newcomers to join us on the "high road." Thank those who invited you and close -- on time!

These 12 suggestions were derived from listening to, identifying, and outlining **the similarities** of structure, content, and order (of delivery) of the talks of many of our beloved carriers **of the AA message**, and can be reconciled within *The Doctor's Opinion* and the first 164 pages of the "Big Book."

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Natural Human Instincts, Defects, Shortcomings; Institutions, Principles of Life & Things.

Natural Human Instincts

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Food
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Human Failings

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Blackouts (loss of memory)

Crave a drink (preoccupation with)

Decreased ambition

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*Adapted from the twenty questions pamphlet - Are you an Alcoholic?

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Negative Attitudes / Personality Traits

...a list of 63 "lesser" defects

- | | | |
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| 21 - Domineering | 42 - Pitiful | 63 - Wrathful |

The above list is a mini-collection of *negative attitudes* and *personality traits* associated with a *maladjusted state* of human development. They will appear most frequently in column 4 of our inventory work in Steps 4 & 10, and column 3 of Step 8. If you are plagued with one which does not appear above, simply insert it wherever it applies.

Pssst! It would serve one well to look up the definitions of these traits and attitudes (pages 80 & 81) in order to gain an understanding of their meaning and subsequent application in our inventory work, recovery process, and our ability to become *adjusted* to the world about us.

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Positive Attitudes / Personality Traits

...a list of 63 "greater" assets

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21- Deferential	42- Commiserable	63- Merciful

The above list is a mini-collection of **positive attitudes** and **personality traits** associated with an **adjusted state** of human development. They are numbered sequentially to match their negative counterparts on page 80.

In regards to Step 10 ... we are sure to have listed a **negative attitude or trait** (from page 80) in Column 4 of our inventory work. This being the case, locate the **positive attitude / trait** above that is associated numerically with that attitude or trait, and list it in column 5 under "new ideas."

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List of Notebook Definitions

Definitions followed by a single asterisk (*) have either been written or expanded upon by the author in an effort to associate the word more closely to the work we are doing within the 12 Steps. All excerpts, footnotes, and definitions followed by a double asterisk (**) have been taken from the book Alcoholics Anonymous and/or the book Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions and are ©AA World Services - reprinted with permission.

- [1] Afraid — A *temporary* or *continual* state of fear.
- [2] Air* — To breathe. *In relation to this inventory*, it is our *personal space*; our freedom to come and go; to do and be as we please.
- [3] Alcoholism* — The presence of the symptoms of *The Ism Factor*¹ in an individual combined with alcohol, the results of which bring about an unnatural *extemporaneous* effect in the mind, causing the afflicted person to experience *an altered perception of reality*; an *illusionary* sensation of being *normal*,² adjusted, natural - natural in the sense that everything is with them as it is in life with most others - they fit in, feel a part of, sense they belong, and feel they are not separated from & different compared to their fellows.
¹ See definition #42 ² See definition #50 ³ See also page 21, Alcoholics Anonymous
- [4] Ambition — A desire for rank, power, or fame.
- [5] Amend — To put right - to change for the better.
- [6] Anger — Emotional excitement induced by injury.
- [7] Apart — Separated; isolated; divided.
- [8] Belief — Deliberate acceptance and intellectual assent.
- [9] Belligerent Denial — An individuals *need to believe* everything is *fine*, even when faced with overwhelming evidence to the contrary - to the point of losing everything worthwhile in life - while at the same time blaming people, places, circumstances and events for their troubles.
- [10] Bluster — To speak or conduct oneself in a noisy, swaggering, or bullying manner; to force by blustering; to bully.
- [11] Bottom* — An untenable state of mind, body, and spirit, complicated with and exacerbated by unrelenting feelings of despair, hopelessness, and futility.
- [12] Compliance — A yielding to a wish, request, or demand; acquiescence.
- [13] Conduct — To act and behave in a particular manner.
- [14] Confusion* — The "effect produced" in the mind of a (new) person (prospect) when they are confronted with an idea rooted in common sense, an idea which is diametrically opposed to their own idea or mindset.
- [15] Conviction — A firmly and seriously held belief.
- [16] Defect — Lack of something necessary for completeness.
- [17] Defiance — Resolute resistance. Intentionally provocative behavior or attitude; a challenge. Defy or resist an opposing force or authority.
- [18] Deny — To refuse to recognize or acknowledge; disown; disavow; repudiate.
- [19] Design — Plan for action.
- [20] Different — Partly or totally unlike in nature, form, or quality; distinction or discrimination in preference; disagreement of opinion; dissension.
- [21] Dilemma — A problem seemingly incapable of solution.
- [22] Dishonest — The act or practice of telling a lie, cheating, stealing, deceiving, etcetera.

4th Step Notes, Definitions and Instructions -- continued.

Self Esteem - How I think of myself

Pride - How I think others view me

Pocketbook - Basic desire for money, property, possessions, etc.

Personal Relations - Our relations with other people.

Emotional Security - General sense of emotional well being

Sex Relations - Basic drive for sexual intimacy

Selfish, self-centered, egotistical - "It's about me!"

Ambitions - Our goals, plans and designs for the future. Ambition deals with the things that we *want*. In examining our ambitions we notice that we have the following types:

Emotional ambitions. Our ambitions for Emotional Security. Our "feelings".

Material ambitions - Our ambitions for "Our pocketbook." Our ambitions towards physical and financial well-being.

Social ambitions - Our "place or position in the herd." Our ambitions of how others view us. Our ambitions towards what people think about us.

Sexual ambitions - Refers to ambitions for sex relations. Does this really need a definition?